



B MANOJ

Game Designer · Gameplay · Combat · Level Design

Bengaluru, India · Open to relocation & WFO
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Portfolio: bmanoj07112004-eng.github.io/B-Manoj-Portfolio

Steam: BLACKOUT ARENA

Video:youtu.be/GdPYPrzWhKs

Shipped on Steam

Blackout Arena · UE5 · 2026

3.5 years

Game design & development

~16 hours

Idea → playable prototype

Design + build

Blueprints · C++ · AI tools

■ PROFILE

Game Designer with **3.5 years of hands-on game design and development** and a commercial release: **BLACKOUT ARENA**, a third-person action-adventure in **Unreal Engine 5** that I co-developed as Lead Game Designer and released on **Steam in April 2026**. I design core loops, combat, enemy encounters, levels and missions, then build and test them myself in **Blueprints and C++**, using AI tools to move fast. Seeking my first studio Game Designer role, ready to contribute from day one.

■ GAME DESIGN EXPERIENCE

Lead Game Designer & Co-Developer: BLACKOUT ARENA

2025 – Present

Red Deck Studio (independent studio I founded) · Bengaluru

Released on Steam 15 Apr 2026 · UE5 · Third-person action-adventure · PC + controller · Co-developed with Shreepati Gaonkar

- Owned the game design for a **mission-driven single-player campaign**. Defined the core loop (explore → discover → fight → survive → descend), with risk rising the deeper the player goes.
- Designed **combat encounters and enemy behaviour** for the ruin guardians; built their AI with **Behavior Trees and Blackboard** and balanced stats, pacing and difficulty in **spreadsheets**.
- Designed **handcrafted levels** (jungle paths, temples, underground ritual chambers) with **environmental storytelling**: carved symbols, relics and secret chambers that reward exploration.
- Wrote the **GDD and feature/mission specs**; shaped the Folk Heroes lore and mystery structure behind mission progression.
- Implemented gameplay in **Blueprints and C++**, built cinematic story beats in **Sequencer**, and used **Nanite and Lumen** for cinematic lighting.
- Ran **playtest → debug → iterate** cycles from the first public demo (early 2026) to Steam release, including store page, controller support and a GTX 1650 minimum spec. Used **AI tools** to speed up scripting, content and testing.

OUTLANDER · Lead Game Designer · UE5 sci-fi survival adventure · In early production

- Designing a survival adventure built around **exploration, scarcity** and making a hostile world liveable.

Independent Game Designer & Developer

2023 – 2025

Self-directed · Bengaluru

- Learned fundamentals in **Unity** (about 6 months), then moved to **Unreal Engine 5** as my main engine.
- Designed and built prototypes across genres: **online multiplayer (Unity + Photon PUN)**, story-driven, horror, combat systems, enemy AI, environments and level design.
- Delivered freelance web and mobile projects directly to clients, from brief to shipped build: real experience with scope, deadlines and feedback.

■ OTHER PROJECTS

- Hamster Game, rapid prototype (2026, solo):** a funny, hamster-themed casual browser game, idea to playable first version in **about 16 hours**; now re-prototyping it in UE5. lnkd.in/p/g7zQ_iun
- OptaLead, AI agents and automation platform (shipped):** AI voice-call and WhatsApp workflow platform; the same AI-workflow skills I use to speed up game production. youtu.be/NtDdmXQsikA

■ SKILLS

Game Design	Core gameplay loops, combat design, enemy & encounter design, level design, mission design, player progression, difficulty balancing, environmental storytelling, player experience
Unreal Engine 5	Blueprints, C++, Behavior Trees & Blackboard, Sequencer, Nanite, Lumen, Steam release
Documentation	Game Design Document (GDD), feature & mission specs, spreadsheet-based balancing
Process	Rapid prototyping, playtesting, testing & debugging, iteration, AI-accelerated workflows
Also	Unity, Photon PUN (multiplayer), AI agents & automation

Design case study, gameplay video & screenshots in my portfolio

Happy to take a game design test